

Character Profile: Benjamin Sloan

A hidden antagonist from my Comfy Summer Jam 2026 project, Finders Keepers. You can play the game yourself here: <https://shinyndas.itch.io/finders-keepers>

Summary: A shrewd businessman with a silver tongue. Will do everything he can to sweeten the deal, lie, twist, and manipulate to get his way. Puts on a sweet face for the player character, and supports their efforts wholeheartedly. Wants to capitalize on the end of the world. Is working for a mysterious benefactor who wants a particularly rare item. Designed to be the driving force behind the game's limitation: "the instructions are a lie".

Appearance: A grey-haired caucasian man in his early fifties; pudgy with a smidge of muscle from his weightlifting days; never caught dead wearing anything but black turtlenecks and gold chains. His signature grin is a facade he puts up to tear down social barriers and win over his worst enemies.

Personality: Manipulative and cunning, occasionally to his own detriment. Insists on the business practices of never burning bridges and making opportunities out of losses. An optimistic, charismatic man with a hard heart and biblical greed.

Wants: Money, plain and simple. Uses the player character as a tool to corner the market during a calamitous event, with the intention of monopolizing basic goods from the comfort of his "humble" pawn shop.

In-Game Behavior: Helps introduce the player to the game mechanics of buying and selling treasures, solidifying himself as an important NPC. Sells the player gear to let them delve deeper into the different layers of the ocean desert, and buys anything and everything, even others' belongings, if the player is willing to sell. It is implied that he knew ahead of time the apocalypse was coming, all due to a mysterious benefactor who requests an artifact of arcane origin for a high asking price. Ben encourages the player character to find this artifact in exchange for a small fortune.